

or MediaTek Dimensity 7200 chipsets. But then again, it's also better since there is competition that is offering lower-end chips like the Snapdragon 6 Gen 1 in a similar price range.

With that out of the way, let's talk numbers and experience. The Samsung Galaxy M55 5G showcased rather low numbers in comparison to some of the competitors. On AnTuTu, the Samsung Galaxy M55 5G showcased a score of below 600,000, which is lower than that of competing devices like the OnePlus Nord CE4 or the Nothing Phone (2a), but ahead of the Oppo Reno 11, which is slightly pricier than the Samsung Galaxy M55.

On Geekbench, the Samsung Galaxy M55 5G scored 947 points in the single core test and 2357 points in the multi-core test. This, while still being lower than the competition, isn't that far behind. In GPU-based tests also, the Samsung Galaxy M55 5G is no "monster" but gaming on the smartphone is still a decent experience. I played a bit of Call of Duty Warzone Mobile on the Samsung Galaxy M55 and the experience was just fine. Yes, it won't give you a constant high FPS like the flagships or the graphics settings are limited, but the gameplay was just fine for any average smartphone gamer.

While talking about performance, one of the most important aspects is the complete software experience and while Samsung's OneUI is one of my favourite UI's out there, the difference is evident in flagships and budget mid-rangers. There is a little bit of bloatware on the Samsung Galaxy M55 and there are a bunch of ads on the home screen, thanks to the "Glance" feature which is turned on by default. I wonder how many buyers will be able to or bother switching it off.

BATTERY AND CHARGING

In the battery also we are seeing a bit of a downgrade, but not really. Confusing, right? Let me explain. While we are getting the fastest possible charging on a Samsung smartphone with 45W fast charging, the battery

has been downsized to 5,000mAh as compared to the 6,000mAh unit on the Samsung Galaxy M54 5G last year. Now, I know all this comparison doesn't matter since the Samsung Galaxy M54 didn't launch in India, but Samsung is the only brand offering 6,000mAh battery as standard in many segments so it is important to mention that the predecessor also had a 6,000mAh unit. The battery backup, however, is just fine. I opened the smartphone at a battery level of about 68 percent and without charging the phone I ran all the tests and used the camera for some time and the smartphone still had about 10 percent of the battery left.

Playing Call of Duty: Mobile for 15 minutes drained the smartphone's battery by 4 percent, so did watching an HDR YouTube video for 30 minutes. The GPS navigation, however, took about 6 percent of the Samsung Galaxy M55 5G's battery, which is great and one of the most efficient in this segment.

The 45W charging, on the other hand, took about 80 minutes to charge from 0 to 100 percent, which is great. This is exactly the same charging speed that we are also getting with Samsung's flagship smartphones like the Samsung Galaxy S24 Ultra or the Samsung Galaxy Z Fold 5, or even the Samsung Galaxy S24 Plus this year.

CAMERA

The camera on the Samsung Galaxy M55 is a triple rear camera setup which includes a 50-megapixel primary shooter, an 8-megapixel ultrawide angle lens, and a 2-megapixel macro shooter.

Now, the images from the primary shooter are pretty good. Before clicking the photo, you will notice a bit of a watercolour effect in the viewfinder. But once you click the image and the phone does its processing, the results are good. We have sufficient dynamic range and the details are also ample. At times, the highlights get blown up in extremely bright conditions, but apart from that, the images are pretty solid.

In low light also, the images are nicely sharp and detailed. All that the smartphone does in night mode is slow down the shutter speed to 7 seconds or 8 seconds and then apply the algorithms to create the image and the results are quite nice. The only thing while shooting in low light is that you need to hold your camera position for 7-8 seconds, which is not always possible. The results, however, are good enough.

VERDICT

So the Samsung Galaxy M55 5G has one of the most premium look and feel on any M-series smartphone that I have used so far, but that doesn't make it good. There are quite a few downgrades as compared to last year's Samsung Galaxy M54, but then again, the M54 didn't come to India so it doesn't really matter.

What impressed me the most about this smartphone is the camera. Despite not having one of the best hardware and despite not being a camera-centric device, the Samsung Galaxy M55 5G still gets it right in many situations. The battery backup is also very good, and the charging is the fastest we have seen on any Samsung device. So my opinion, as you can clearly see, is mixed on this device. We are getting Samsung's OneUI, but with bloatware and ads. We are getting a smaller battery, but the backup remains very good. We are getting a slightly less detailed display (on paper), but the quality is still great. So yes, the Samsung Galaxy M55 5G is a bit of a mixed bag when it comes to a sub-Rs 25,000 smartphone.

—Darab Mansoor Ali

SPECIFICATIONS

Chipset: Qualcomm Snapdragon 7 Gen 1 | GPU: Adreno 644 | OS: OneUI 6.1 based on Android 14 | Display: 6.7-inch FHD+ sAMOLED display | Display Refresh Rate: 120Hz | RAM: Up to 12GB | ROM: Up to 256GB | Cameras (rear): 50MP + 8MP + 2MP | Cameras (front): 50MP | Video: 4K @ 30fps | Battery: 5000mAh | Charging: 45W

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